MERIDIAN · THE CUSTODIAN LOTTERY REPUBLIC

The Architecture of the Custodian Lottery Republic

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> **Humaninity** — the unexplainable truths and values that a functional human is. The quality the Custodian Lottery Republic exists to protect.

This document follows The Meridian Charter. Where any document in the archive differs from the Charter, the Charter governs.

Introduction

The Custodian Lottery Republic (CLR) is a design for a state in which ordinary people, chosen by lot, decide what the country will do; a permanent, radically transparent public service does it; and the whole population has the final say on the questions that matter most. This overview is the short, plain-language version. The full design, with every body, threshold and precedent, is *The Meridian Charter*, and where this document is briefer than the Charter, the Charter governs.

The Republic exists to protect **Humaninity**: the unexplainable truths and values that a functional human is. Most governance failures are not failures of competence; they are failures where a system becomes very good at the thing it can measure and quietly drops the thing it cannot. Every part of the CLR is shaped to keep that from happening.

The Three Pillars

Pillar	Who	What it does
The Assembly (Sortition)	300 citizens drawn by stratified lottery from the electoral roll, no competency test, three-year terms with one-third rotating each year, no one serving twice.	Sets the agenda. Nothing becomes law, policy or a referendum question unless the Assembly has put it there. Writes plain-language *Requirements*, commissions competing drafts, passes ordinary law, supervises every Custodian directorate in public.

Pillar	Who	What it does
The Custodians (Permanent Service)	A merit-appointed, tenured public service built around an AI layer whose purpose is to make the service legible.	Executes Requirements and referendum results. May report a problem; may never propose a solution unasked. *A public servant, with the emphasis on servant.*
The Public (Direct Democracy)	Everyone, with compulsory voting as Australia already has.	Four fixed referendum days a year in normal times. Emergency referendums, as often as weekly, on questions of war and peace only, once a state of armed conflict has been declared by referendum. Final say on the constitution, rights, war, and the structure of the Custodian layer itself.

How the Pieces Fit

The agenda belongs to the lottery. This is the single most important rule. In most systems the real power is deciding what gets decided; here that power sits only with people who were drawn, serve briefly, and go home.

Custodians serve, they do not steer. Their authority is wholly derivative. Where a Requirement is silent on who is to be served, their duty is to report the silence and hold course, not to fill it. A long-staggered **Constitutional Jury** of 48 citizens, advised by three judges, rules on whether any Custodian act was *execution* (permitted) or *policy* (forbidden).

The AI is the witness, not the sovereign. It is required, not optional, because a human bureaucracy of two hundred thousand people cannot be audited and an AI-administered one can: every decision records what was asked, what rule was applied and what was rejected, in a form a lottery panel can read. It may hold no objective the Assembly has not adopted, may decide nothing about a named person without a human signature, and is plural by law (at least two independent systems, disagreements published). A **Humaninity Audit** of sixty citizens drawn by lot hunts for places where the system is succeeding by its measures and failing by its people, and can suspend any automated process for ninety days.

The public holds the last word, and feels its weight. Quarterly referendums keep the normal rhythm calm. Wartime emergency referendums are exhausting by design: a Republic that could go to war without asking would not be a CLR.

The Gaps Every Constitution Has to Fill

- **Head of state.** The **Speaker of the Republic**, drawn by lot from citizens who have completed an Assembly term in the past ten years, confirmed by the Assembly, three years, non-renewable. Signs what the Assembly or the public has approved; may refuse only on process, never on the merits.
- **Judges.** Nominated by a Custodian **Judicial Commission**, confirmed in public by a lottery **Judicial Jury** of 36, appointed by the Speaker, removable only by referendum.
- **Treaties and foreign affairs.** The Assembly adopts a *Foreign Requirement*; the Custodian Directorate of External Affairs negotiates inside it and brings the text back for a vote; treaties involving force, jurisdiction or long commitments also go to referendum.
- **War.** Declared by referendum at sixty per cent. A **War Panel** of thirty Assembly members, rotating in thirds every six months, instructs the Defence Directorate and frames the emergency questions. No one in uniform ever decides to begin or to stop.
- **The states.** Unchanged. A state may adopt the model on its own, which is the implementation path proposed for Australia.

Key Concepts and Definitions

- **Humaninity:** the unexplainable truths and values that a functional human is; the first constitutional principle.
- **Requirement:** a plain-language instruction from the Assembly saying what a law must achieve, what it must not do and whom it must protect. Public from the moment it is adopted.
- **Competing drafts:** every bill is drafted at least twice, once by the Custodian Office of Legislative Counsel and once by an independent body, with the AI publishing a clause-by-clause comparison against the Requirement.
- **Staggered terms:** three years, one-third rotating each year, so there are always members who have seen a budget, a crisis and a referendum before, and never a cohort old enough to become a class.
- **Execution vs policy:** the boundary of Custodian power, policed by the Constitutional Jury.
- **The social floor:** universal housing, health and education, a caregiver income, and full income replacement for anyone serving on any lottery body. Stated broadly on purpose: in Australia it is a question of political will and resource rents, not of inventing wealth.

Component Map: What Goes With What

Body	Chosen by	Term	Role
Assembly (300)	Lottery	3 yrs, staggered	Agenda, Requirements, ordinary law
Standing panels	Lottery, from Assembly	Member's term	Supervise each directorate
Humaninity Audit (60)	Lottery	3 yrs, staggered	Find metric-success / human-failure; 90-day suspension
Information Panels (24)	Lottery	Per question	Certify referendum packets as fair
Judicial Jury (36)	Lottery	Per vacancy	Confirm judges
Constitutional Jury (48)	Lottery	3 yrs, staggered	Execution or policy?
War Panel (30)	Lottery, from Assembly	Conflict, rotating	Instruct Defence; frame emergency questions
Speaker	Lottery from ex-members	3 yrs	Head of state; signs; refuses on process only
Custodian directorates	Merit	Career	Execute; report; never initiate
Judicial Commission (9)	Senior Custodians	6 yrs, staggered	Nominate judges
The public	Everyone	Life	Quarterly and emergency referendums; final say

Every body that holds power over direction is chosen by lot. Every body chosen by merit is forbidden from holding power over direction. That is the whole design.

Implementation Path

1. **Shadow assemblies.** Lottery bodies run alongside existing parliaments, publishing Requirements the parliament is obliged to answer (the Ostbelgien model).

2. **State pilots.** One state adopts a lottery Assembly with agenda power over a defined domain, with its public service bound to execution-only within it.
3. **Section 128.** A federal referendum, carried nationally and in a majority of states, adopting the Charter.

References

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